

Can competition among individuals from the same species affect their growth?

The following procedure will help you set up your experimental containers for this experiment:

Materials needed

- 3 small containers with lids
- Bottle of *Lemna* media
- Dish of *Lemna* plants
- Blue transfer loop
- 100mL Graduated cylinder
- Roll of tape and a Sharpie marker

Procedure

1. Each group should grab their 3 containers and label them with a piece of tape.
2. On the label, you should write a group name for yourselves.
3. In addition, label each container with a different letter, either "A", "B" or "C". These different letters will be the different treatments for this experiment.
4. Use the graduated cylinder to measure out 100mL of *Lemna* media and add it to each of your three containers.
5. Add different amounts of *Lemna minor* plants to each of your 3 containers using the blue transfer loops provided.
 - To the container labelled with an "A", add 2 whole *Lemna* plants (do not worry if they different numbers of leaves). Record this number in your notebook.
 - To the container labelled with a "B", add approximately 75 *Lemna* plants or enough plants until about half of the space in the container is covered with plants. Record this number in your notebook.
 - To the container labelled "C", add about 150 *Lemna* plants or enough plants until the entire surface of the *Lemna* media is covered with plants. Record this number in your notebook.
6. Once the plants have been added, place the lids loosely on top of each container and place them under the grow light in the lab. The plants will be counted when you return.